This earthy soup combines mildly nutty celeriac and more assertive celery to create a fragrant, satisfying winter warmer.

celery and celeriac soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT THE CHILLED BUTTER

1 tbsp sunflower, peanut, or mild-flavored olive oil
2 tbsp butter
1lb 2oz (500g) celeriac, peeled and chopped
1 large head celery, cored and chopped
1 medium floury potato, peeled and chopped
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 quart (1 liter) vegetable stock or chicken stock
2 tbsp chilled butter, diced
4 slices walnut bread, lightly toasted, to serve

1 Put the oil and 2 tbsp butter in a large sauté pan over medium heat. Add the celeriac, celery, and potato. Stir well for 2–3 minutes then reduce the heat a little. Add 3–4 tbsp water, and season lightly. Partially cover and let stew gently until very soft. Stir the vegetables from time to time and keep the heat low.

2 Transfer the cooked vegetables to a food processor and purée. Return to the pan and add the stock. Season, stir briskly to blend, and bring to a simmer over medium heat, stirring frequently. Reduce the heat a little and let simmer gently for 10–15 minutes, still stirring occasionally. Taste and adjust the seasoning.

3 Just before serving, whisk in the chilled diced butter. Serve hot with toasted walnut bread.



CELERY
Most celery found in markets is naturally vibrantly green, but look out for the less bitter blanched white variety, too. Celery's thick outer stalks are best in soups, stews, and casseroles, rather than eaten raw.